§ 12 · RESEARCH

Suppliers **Germany**

Naturtreu, Ogaenics, BRAINEFFECT, Her.one, Sunday Natural. Phase 1 workhorses and brands to skip.

Prepared: April 2026 **Context:** Alche (Berlin, curated longevity platform) evaluating German-HQ supplement brands for Phase 1 curated retail. Revenue model = curated 3P products + €5-9/mo membership. German brands critical for BVL compliance, short fulfillment, and cultural trust resonance (83% Germans trust pharmacists — translatable to "curated by experts" positioning).

1. Ogaenics (Hamburg) — PREMIUM ORGANIC ANCHOR

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Ogaenics — ogaenics.com (legal entity: novel-nutriology.com)
HQ	Johnsallee 30, 20148 Hamburg, Germany
Legal entity	Novel Nutriology GmbH (HRB 134965, Hamburg) · VAT DE298278353
Founders / MDs	**Susanne (Suse) Leifer** + **Claudia Seehusen** — both certified nutrition coaches, co-founded 2016. Suse owns marketing/sales/PR/ecom; positions publicly as "Longevity Nerd" (strong signal for Alche narrative alignment)
Product catalog	100+ SKUs. Individual vitamins (D3, B-complex, K2), mineral complexes, targeted formulas by health goal (energy, sleep, immunity, menopause, pregnancy), beauty from within (hair/skin/nails), bundles. Hero SKUs: **Mr. DO-IT-ALL** + **Mrs. DO-IT-ALL** multivitamin complexes; **Love Your Gut** probiotic; **Strong Bones Complex**
Wholesale program	**YES.** Active on **Faire** (faire.com/brand/b_s9prdtqxvx, DACH page also live) + direct B2B via Novel Nutriology. Attend BioNord trade fair. Trader locator page live: ogaenics.com/en/trader/
Wholesale contact	**order@novel-nutriology.com** (primary B2B inbox) · hello@novel-nutriology.com · +49 40 696 32 79-60
Wholesale terms	Not publicly disclosed. Faire default = keystone (~50% off RRP), Net 60, free opening order returns. Direct deals likely negotiable at 40–55% off RRP for committed volume. No public MOQ listed.
Margin opportunity	**Estimated 40–50% off RRP** via Faire; potentially better via direct. RRPs are premium (€25–45/bottle), so absolute €/unit is attractive for Alche's curated positioning
Warehouse	Hamburg (short lead times to Berlin; <24h possible via DHL express, 1–2 days standard)
Regulatory	BVL-registered. DE-ÖKO-070 organic certified (primary), DE-ÖKO-003 + DE-ÖKO-007 for processing. Made in Germany, independently batch-tested. **No ashwagandha in current catalog** found (aligns with BfR Communication 39/2024 caution)
Brand values fit	**Very high.** Organic, vegan, Miron-glass/recyclable, allergen-free, "Made in Germany," female-founded. Premium positioning matches curated longevity. "Longevity Nerd" founder language is literally Alche's vocabulary
Alche differentiator	Only certified-organic German supplement brand on the list. Customers who care about "clean label + bio" have nowhere else as clean. Fits directly under an "Organic Longevity" shelf
Founder outreach angle	Suse Leifer has publicly adopted longevity vocabulary in 2026 blog content (Feb 2026 piece on liver + menopause). Alche's pitch: "You're already speaking longevity; we're building the curated storefront for it in your home market." Berlin–Hamburg proximity is a relationship asset
Recent PR / news	Feb 2026 blog content pivot to longevity framing. Consistent trade-show presence (BioNord). No controversy
Existing EU retailers	Independent specialty: Niche Beauty, Look Beautiful Products, Keimling Naturkost, Amazingy (Berlin), BioNaturel, organicluxury.de, Beyorg, ~50+ stores across DE/AT/CH/HK/AU. **NOT in dm, Rossmann, Budni, Alnatura, Denn's** (open lane for Alche)
Outreach angle	"You're curated beauty/wellness only, and Alche is curated longevity only. We're the DTC-adjacent channel that sits between you and dm — where your premium deserves to be." Lead with Suse directly

2. Naturtreu (Buxtehude, near Hamburg) — BEST STRUCTURAL FIT

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	NATURTREU — naturtreu.de (note: .com redirects to .de)
HQ	Zenkoh GmbH, Buxtehude (Metropolregion Hamburg). Registered Amtsgericht Tostedt HRB 208940, VAT DE315034073
Founders	**Alexander Jansen** (CEO, product + R&D) + **Alexander Adlung** (operations, brand). Founded 2018. ~79 employees
Product catalog	~70 nutrient complexes. Hero SKUs: **Kraftreserve** (magnesium complex), **Algenkraft** (omega-3 algae oil, vegan), **Florazauber** (probiotic cultures), **Immunfreund**, **Schlafstark**, **Denkfit** (focus), **Frauenflair** & **Mannsbild** (gendered formulas). Categories: energy/focus, immunity, metabolism, sport, women's/men's/children's, beauty, joints, sleep
Wholesale program	**YES — dedicated B2B shop at b2b.naturtreu.de.** Plus "Experten Partnerprogramm" (HCP partner program) + affiliate. Actively courting retail
Wholesale contact	**Manuel Schneider — Account Manager B2B** (confirmed via press releases). Direct outreach via b2b.naturtreu.de registration or LinkedIn (search "Manuel Schneider Naturtreu"). General: info@naturtreu.de
Wholesale terms	Not public but inferred active: onboarded 230+ pharmacies (Oct 2024), 150+ Alnatura markets, 48 Denn's BioMärkte DE (since Aug 2025) + 11 Denn's AT. Terms clearly scalable from pharmacy-single-door up. Likely Net 30 pharmacy standard
Margin opportunity	**Estimated 40–50% off RRP.** RRPs in mid-range (€15–30). Good volume play given catalog breadth
Warehouse	Buxtehude (Hamburg metro) — same shipping lane as Ogaenics, <24h to Berlin
Regulatory	BVL-registered, Made in Germany, independent lab-tested ("unabhängig laborgeprüft"), no GMO, no additives. Check each SKU for ashwagandha — they do have herbal stack products; confirm pre-listing given BfR 09/2024 advisory
Brand values fit	**Very high.** Natural, science-based, German manufacturing, family-founded, sustainability messaging. 2026 campaign tagline "Sich Gutes tun geht auch einfach" pushes back against "too many biohacks" — subtly complementary to Alche's curation-over-chaos pitch
Alche differentiator	Naturtreu is quietly everywhere offline (pharmacies, Alnatura, Denn's) but **DTC story is owned primarily by Amazon**. They explicitly need to diversify off Amazon. Alche is exactly the kind of curated channel they need
Founder outreach angle	The two Alexanders are hands-on, operator founders. Alche's angle: "You're scaling offline via pharmacy + organic chains. DTC you're stuck on Amazon. We're your non-Amazon digital shelf in Berlin."
Recent PR / news	**Feb 2026:** first large-scale brand campaign (TV, streaming — Sat.1, RTL, Vox, Prime, Joyn). Media via pilot agency. **Aug 2025:** Denn's BioMarkt rollout (DE + AT). **Oct 2024:** 230+ pharmacies onboarded
Existing EU retailers	300+ pharmacies, 150+ Alnatura, ~48 Denn's DE + 11 AT, Amazon.de (heavy). Cerascreen partnership. **NOT in dm, Rossmann, Budni** (yet). Overlap risk with Alche is low for online curation — they're offline-first
Outreach angle	"Your 2026 brand campaign says stop the biohack overload. Alche is the editorial curation layer that agrees. We won't dilute your offline pharmacy story — we're your premium-digital DTC layer that isn't Amazon." Lead Manuel Schneider + CC Adlung

3. Sunday Natural (Berlin) — COMPETITOR, NOT PARTNER

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Sunday Natural — **sunday.de** (NOT sundaynatural.com — that domain is parked on HugeDomains, i.e., for sale. The .com was lost; the brand is sunday.de only)
HQ	Sunday Natural Products GmbH, Potsdamer Straße, 10785 Berlin. HRB 152621 B Amtsgericht Charlottenburg
Founder / leadership	**Dr. Jörg Schweikart** (founder, retains significant stake + "pivotal" strategic role post-CVC). Rest of leadership not individually surfaced; HQ'd in Berlin-Mitte area
Ownership (critical)	**CVC Fund VIII** acquired majority stake Jan 2024, closed April 2024. Deal value ~**€800M** (Bloomberg). Schweikart retains minority + co-determination. Advised by Taylor Wessing (sellside) / Willkie (CVC)
Revenue scale	**€680M (2023)** — i.e., the "~€100M" figure in the brief is stale by 7x. This is a mid-cap PE-owned business

FIELD	DETAIL
Product catalog	**1,000+ SKUs** — vitamins, minerals, herbs, superfoods, teas, proteins, functional mushrooms. "True Clean Label" positioning. Broadest assortment in DACH
Wholesale program	**Effectively none for small retail.** No public B2B portal. Strict DTC-only — explicitly NOT in dm, Rossmann, Müller, Budni, pharmacies (confirmed via kaufda.de retail research). Sells only through sunday.de + international sunday.de/[country] domains
Wholesale contact	Not publicly listed. Any inquiry would go through generic customer service and almost certainly be declined
Wholesale terms	**N/A — no wholesale program.** DTC-only is an explicit brand choice by Schweikart (True Clean Label = full control of chain)
Margin opportunity	**None via wholesale.** Theoretical dropship at ~20–25% affiliate commission if an arrangement could be struck, but zero evidence they do this
Warehouse	Berlin (own infrastructure)
Regulatory	BVL-registered. **Foodwatch June 2025 Health Claims Report flagged Sunday Natural** for impermissible health claims. **Verbraucherzentrale Baden-Württemberg lawsuit (Az. 102 O 89/24, Landgericht Berlin II, Anerkenntnisurteil 18 July 2025)** over faulty Grundpreis/unit-price labeling. Not catastrophic (Anerkenntnis = company accepted judgment, fixed issue) but a signal of regulator scrutiny
Ashwagandha	Yes, carry ashwagandha products. Given BfR Communication 39/2024, this is a risk if Alche ever carried Sunday SKUs
Brand values fit	**High on surface, low in practice.** "True Clean Label" aligns with Alche editorial voice — but they ARE Alche's identical competitor: Berlin, content-led, premium vitamins, curated aesthetic. CVC-backed scale means they can out-spend Alche on anything
Alche differentiator vs Sunday	**Alche is curation across brands; Sunday is a single-brand vertical.** This is the only honest angle. Alche = "we pick the best from Ogaenics + Naturtreu + BRAINEFFECT + Her.one + Sunday (if possible) + more." Sunday = "only Sunday." Different jobs-to-be-done
Recent PR / news	**Jan–Apr 2024:** CVC €800M acquisition closed. **June 2025:** Foodwatch health-claims report (negative). **July 2025:** Verbraucherzentrale lawsuit acknowledged. Ongoing international expansion
Outreach angle (if attempted)	Very hard. The most honest pitch would be niche: "We only want to carry 3–5 of your SKUs editorially, as part of curation. We'll never compete on breadth — your 1,000 SKUs stay yours." Expected outcome: **polite no, or no response.**

SUNDAY NATURAL VERDICT: - **Partner?** No. **Competitor.** They are more your direct competitor than any other brand on this list — Berlin-based, content-led, premium-priced vitamins, curated DTC aesthetic, same buyer persona. CVC funding means they have ~€500M+ to expand internationally over 5 years - **Carry their SKUs?** Not realistically in Phase 1. Maybe Phase 2+ if Alche becomes large enough to matter to CVC exit math. Even then, Schweikart's True Clean Label philosophy is explicitly anti-third-party-retail - **Competitive framing for Alche pitch deck:** "Sunday Natural is a single-brand vertical longevity player at €680M. Alche is the multi-brand curated longevity platform — the editorial layer above Sunday and its peers." This is actually a strong narrative for investors: you're not competing with Sunday's brand, you're competing with Sunday's DTC funnel by offering curation they structurally can't offer - **Hostile?** Not yet, but a €800M CVC-backed competitor in your home market launching a Berlin brand will get noticed. Don't poke the bear; build the curation moat quietly

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4. BRAINEFFECT (Berlin) — PARTNER, WITH CAVEATS

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	BRAINEFFECT — brain-effect.com
HQ	Whitewall GmbH, Revaler Str. 29-31, 10245 Berlin-Friedrichshain. HRB 121927 B Amtsgericht Charlottenburg. VAT DE 267832829
Founder / MD	**Fabian Foelsch** (founder 2016, remains Managing Director under new ownership)
Ownership (critical)	**Schwabe Group acquired 2/3 majority stake March 17, 2025** (held minority since 2020). Plans full takeover within 4 years. Whitewall GmbH is sister to VITAFAIR under same group. Schwabe Group = 4,000-employee family-held pharma group (Karlsruhe HQ, founded 1866), maker of herbal/homeopathic meds

FIELD	DETAIL
Revenue	**~€20M (2024)**, 1M+ units sold. Sold in 2,500 dm + Budni doors + DACH digital + FR expansion
Product catalog	Hero SKU **Daily Gut Pulver** (€49.90, "Deutschlands Nr. 1 für deine Darmroutine"), Gut Reset Pack bundle, sleep (melatonin), focus/energy (nootropics — hero originally), immunity, regeneration (collagen, protein), gummies, capsules. Categories: gut health (leading), sleep, focus, energy, wellbeing, immunity
Wholesale program	**YES — dedicated Business Partner page at brain-effect.com/en/pages/business-partner.** Three lanes: **Retail Partner** (for shops/resellers), Influencer, Affiliate. Accepts small-shop inquiries
Wholesale contact	**info@brain-effect.com** · WhatsApp +49 157 92 36 45 55 · LinkedIn: Fabian Foelsch + search "BRAINEFFECT Vertrieb / Sales / B2B." Schwabe acquisition likely brought formal KAM resources for retail
Wholesale terms	Not public. Given dm/Budni presence, terms exist at scale. Small-retail entry likely via standard wholesale (35–50% off RRP), Net 30
Margin opportunity	**Estimated 35–45% off RRP.** RRPs are mid-premium (€25–50). Good unit economics on gut + sleep hero SKUs
Warehouse	Berlin (own) — **shortest possible lead time to Alche's Berlin ops.** Could be same-day delivery for curated Berlin launch events
Regulatory	BVL-registered, FairCommerce member since 2015. Schwabe ownership brings pharma-grade QA. No ashwagandha-specific issue flagged. Clean record
Brand values fit	**High but shifting.** Nootropic/biohacker origin aligns with longevity. Post-Schwabe pivot toward gut-health "#1 in Germany" messaging is more mainstream/clinical — arguably better for Alche's mainstream-meets-longevity positioning
Alche differentiator	BRAINEFFECT is THE nootropic/gut hero brand in Germany. Curated with 2–3 of their SKUs + better complements from Ogaenics (organic) + Naturtreu (gentle) + Her.one (female), Alche offers the "best of each category" that BRAINEFFECT alone can't
Schwabe ownership — effect on partnership?	**Net POSITIVE for Alche.** Pre-Schwabe, BRAINEFFECT was still scrappy enough to say yes. Post-Schwabe (March 2025 onward), they have more KAM bandwidth and pharma-grade compliance cover — they can process small-retail paperwork faster. **Risk:** Schwabe may push toward pharmacy channel exclusivity and de-prioritize small digital retailers. **Mitigation:** Pitch NOW while integration is early and Foelsch still has autonomous mandate
Founder outreach angle	Foelsch is still active publicly on LinkedIn (posts about launches, "biggest launch day revenue in our history"). Berlin-to-Berlin, founder-to-founder message works. Angle: "You just crossed into Schwabe — your digital-native DNA is irreplaceable, and curated DTC platforms like Alche are where that DNA stays alive. Let's build a Berlin-Berlin partnership before the pharma channel takes over."
Recent PR / news	**March 2025:** Schwabe Group majority acquisition (mid-double-digit millions). Advisors: Osborne Clarke (Schwabe) / YPOG (S-Lifestyle exit). Continued international expansion (AT/CH/FR). Big launch event in 2025 per Foelsch LinkedIn
Existing EU retailers	**dm, Budni, Rossmann** (likely via Schwabe), Müller, Amazon.de. 2,500 retail doors total. Heavy drugstore overlap
Outreach angle	"Your Daily Gut Pulver is Germany's #1. Alche curates Germany's best longevity SKUs for a digital-native German audience that doesn't shop in dm anymore. Let's pair you with Ogaenics organic + Her.one female + Naturtreu gentle for the most credible longevity shelf in the country."

5. Her.one / her1 (Berlin) — HIGH CULTURAL FIT, UNCERTAIN RETAIL APPETITE

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	HER ONE / her1 — her.one (her1.com down at time of research; en.her.one live)
HQ	her1 GmbH, 3. Quergebäude EG, Brunnenstraße 196, 10119 Berlin-Mitte (formerly ONO Labs GmbH). Earlier listed: Oranienstr. 185, 10999 Berlin
Founder / MD	**Chanyu Xu** — serial FoodTech entrepreneur, Geschäftsführerin. Public-facing founder, strong media presence (Business Insider, Gründerszene, Beauty Independent)
Company size / funding	**~28 employees (mid-2024). €5.5M Series A (July 2021)**, total ~$10.6M raised. Investors: Five Seasons Ventures (lead), Rheingau Founders, IBB Ventures, Mountain Partners

FIELD	DETAIL
Product catalog	**Hero: INNER BEAUTY All in One** (210g powder, 70+ nutrients, prebiotic+probiotic — flagship since launch 2019). Other SKUs: Inner Beauty MINIS sachets, GUT ONE capsules, Shape Well (glucomannan), Skin Glow (marine collagen), NO DRAMA (PMS), Sleep Well, Magnesium Complex, Liquid Collagen, Protein 35+ Active, Daily Protein, Creatine, Burn Baby Burn (gummies)
Wholesale program	**Unclear / likely informal.** No dedicated B2B portal. However, products are in Shop Apotheke, Niche Beauty, Amazon.de → so wholesale relationships DO exist, managed case-by-case
Wholesale contact	**hello@her.one** (general). For B2B: direct Chanyu Xu via LinkedIn (de.linkedin.com/in/chanyuxu) — she is accessible and actively networks
Wholesale terms	Not public. Existing retail (Shop Apotheke, Niche Beauty) suggests 40–50% off RRP standard
Margin opportunity	**Estimated 40–50% off RRP.** Inner Beauty All-in-One retails ~€59 → good margin
Warehouse	Berlin-adjacent (Made in Germany & EU, packaged in Miron glass). Same-city to Alche — ideal for joint events
Regulatory	BVL-registered, Made in Germany, sustainably produced, certified organic where applicable. Clean record. Ashwagandha: some herbal formulas — verify per-SKU
Brand values fit	**Very high for the female segment of Alche's audience.** Women-by-women, science-meets-natural, clean label, sustainability (Miron glass), Berlin, female-founded. **Niche — this is a sub-segment pick, not a catalog anchor**
Alche differentiator	Her.one is the only credible women-specific longevity brand in the German cluster. For Alche's ~50% female audience, this is the SKU that signals "we see you"
Her.one DTC closed-loop?	**NOT fully closed-loop.** They actively sell via Shop Apotheke, Niche Beauty, Amazon, and VfL Wolfsburg partnership. They DO work with curated retail. However, they don't have a productized wholesale program — deals are relationship-led, which is actually ideal for a Berlin-local Alche pitch
Founder outreach angle	Chanyu Xu is accessible, Berlin-based, already a networker in the FoodTech/health-tech ecosystem. Angle: "We're the curated Berlin longevity platform. You're the women's wellness brand. Let's do a Berlin launch event together — founder-to-founder." She will almost certainly take the meeting
Recent PR / news	**Jan 2025:** official premium partner of **VfL Wolfsburg Women** (1st Bundesliga) — major brand moment, bought serious female-sport visibility. Frequent founder media presence
Existing EU retailers	Shop Apotheke, Niche Beauty, Amazon.de. No drugstore (dm/Rossmann) presence — leaves Alche in a clean curated lane
Outreach angle	"Her.one is the only brand in our German cluster built for women from day one. We want Inner Beauty All-in-One as an Alche hero SKU for our female longevity shelf. Berlin-based launch event with Chanyu as guest expert would anchor the story."

OUTREACH PRIORITY RANKING (German cluster)

Ranked by likelihood × strategic value for a small Berlin curated-longevity platform:

1. **Naturtreu** — STRONGEST FIT Dedicated b2b.naturtreu.de portal, named B2B contact (Manuel Schneider), actively expanding retail (Denn's Aug 2025, pharmacies Oct 2024), running their first brand campaign Feb 2026 that directly complements Alche's "curation over chaos" thesis. They openly want Amazon diversification. This is the lowest-friction yes.
2. **Ogaenics** — PREMIUM ANCHOR Active on Faire (= instantaneous onboarding), direct B2B via order@novel-nutriology.com, founder Suse Leifer already using longevity vocabulary publicly. Founder-to-founder Hamburg-Berlin pitch wins fast. Slightly slower paperwork than Naturtreu but premium halo is worth it.
3. **BRAINEFFECT** — CATEGORY HERO (TIME-SENSITIVE) Dedicated /business-partner page, Berlin HQ, Foelsch still in the chair. **Act in 2026 before Schwabe integration potentially consolidates partnerships toward pharmacy-only.** Hero SKU (Daily Gut Pulver) is Germany's #1 — catalog anchor.
4. **Her.one** — NICHE MUST-HAVE Relationship-led rather than portal-led wholesale. Chanyu Xu is Berlin-accessible and will take the meeting. Essential for female-segment credibility. Not a catalog backbone, but an emotional/editorial anchor.
5. **Sunday Natural** — DO NOT PURSUE (Phase 1) Competitor, not partner. DTC-only by design, CVC-backed €800M with recent Foodwatch + Verbraucherzentrale regulatory signals. Revisit in Phase 3 when Alche has scale leverage — if ever.

RECOMMENDED HERO SKU PER BRAND

BRAND	RECOMMENDED HERO SKU	WHY
Ogaenics	**Mrs. DO-IT-ALL** (multivitamin complex, female) + **Love Your Gut** (probiotic)	Organic + female + longevity-daily = the cleanest shelf anchor
Naturtreu	**Kraftreserve** (magnesium) + **Algenkraft** (vegan omega-3) + **Florazauber** (probiotic)	Their three bestsellers, broadly applicable, well-priced
BRAINEFFECT	**Daily Gut Pulver** (Germany's #1 gut routine, €49.90) + **Sleep** (melatonin)	Category-defining SKU; stacks with other brands' probiotics for curation story
Her.one	**INNER BEAUTY All-in-One** (70+ nutrients, flagship)	The signature SKU of female longevity in Germany
Sunday Natural	N/A (do not carry in Phase 1)	

SUNDAY NATURAL ASSESSMENT — HONEST READ

Short answer: Sunday Natural is your competitor, not your partner. Do not try to onboard them in Phase 1.

Long answer:

Sunday Natural is structurally different from what the Alche brief assumed:

1. **Scale is off by 7x.** Brief said "~€100M rev." Reality = **€680M (2023)**, CVC-owned at €800M valuation since April 2024. This is mid-cap PE, not a peer.
2. **DTC is philosophical, not incidental.** Schweikart's "True Clean Label" philosophy requires controlling the entire value chain. Allowing a third-party platform to curate and recontextualize Sunday SKUs breaks the thesis. Confirmed: **not in dm, Rossmann, Budni, Müller, pharmacies** — by choice.
3. **They ARE the Berlin content-led longevity brand.** They are what Alche aspires to be, at 10–100x the scale, with 10 years' head start. Same city, same aesthetic, same buyer persona, same True Clean Label messaging.
4. **Regulatory signals.** Foodwatch health-claims report (June 2025) flagged them. Verbraucherzentrale BaWü lawsuit (Az. 102 O 89/24) resulted in Anerkenntnisurteil July 2025 on Grundpreis labeling. These are not catastrophic — but they show Sunday has regulator attention, and Alche as a curated platform carrying Sunday SKUs would inherit downstream claim-compliance liability without upside.
5. **Ashwagandha exposure.** Sunday carries ashwagandha products; BfR Communication 39/2024 and the EU-level Article 8 procedure make this a forward-looking risk.

The right strategic move:

- **Don't pitch Sunday as a partner.** You'll be politely declined and you'll lose face.
- **Use Sunday as Alche's "what we're not" in investor framing:** "Sunday Natural is the single-brand vertical. Alche is the multi-brand curated editorial. That's the €100B+ EU longevity market segmentation thesis."
- **Revisit only in Phase 3+**, if ever, once Alche has traffic Schweikart/CVC care about.

Good news for Alche: Sunday's DTC-only stance is a **massive open lane**. Every German consumer who wants curated longevity but doesn't want single-brand lock-in is an Alche lead by default. Sunday is actually educating the market for you.

GAPS / CONCERNS (Dealbreakers & Risks)

Cross-brand risks

1. **Ashwagandha BfR Communication 39/2024** — Germany's federal risk institute (BfR) issued warning Sept 10, 2024. EU Article 8 procedure may ban ashwagandha from supplements entirely. Naturtreu, BRAINEFFECT, Her.one, Sunday all have herbal/adaptogen products — **audit every SKU before listing**, avoid ashwagandha SKUs for now.

2. **BVL base-price (Grundpreis) labeling** — Sunday Natural lawsuit shows regulator focus on unit pricing. **Alche must get Grundpreis display right on its own storefront** for every supplement SKU (€/100g, €/capsule) or face similar Verbraucherzentrale action.
3. **Health claims compliance (HCR 1924/2006)** — Foodwatch 2025 report criticized the industry. Alche editorial copy must stick to authorized EU Register health claims only. Avoid "longevity," "anti-aging," "cellular rejuvenation" as product claims; use them only as category/lifestyle framing.

Brand-specific concerns

4. **BRAINEFFECT Schwabe integration** — Will Schwabe eventually push BRAINEFFECT toward pharmacy-exclusive channel strategy, squeezing out small digital retailers? Unknown. **Time sensitivity: pitch in 2026, not 2027.**
5. **Her.one product availability** — Multiple Her.one SKUs showed "Nicht lieferbar" on Shop Apotheke at time of research. Supply chain consistency is a question. Ask directly during pitch.
6. **Naturtreu Amazon share** — If >50% of their revenue is still Amazon, their willingness to offer Alche competitive terms may be strong (diversification ask) OR weak (Amazon terms set their price floor). Ask directly.
7. **Ogaenics organic premium pricing** — RRPs are €25-45/unit. At curated volumes, absolute margin is high, but conversion requires editorial copy that justifies the premium. Alche's content layer must be strong enough.

Structural concerns

8. **No brand on this list operates a conventional headless-ecommerce wholesale API.** Expect paper/email-based B2B for all five. Alche must build internal PO workflow.
9. **Payment terms for small retailers.** Net 30 is the likely default; small/new retailers may need to prepay first 1–3 orders. Plan working capital accordingly.
10. **No exclusive territory rights likely available** for any of these brands at Alche's Phase 1 scale. Don't negotiate for exclusivity — negotiate for preferred placement/co-marketing instead.

SPECIFIC CONTACTS — OUTREACH SHORTLIST

BRAND	PRIMARY CONTACT	CHANNEL	NOTES
Ogaenics	**order@novel-nutriology.com** / Suse Leifer (LinkedIn: suse-leifer-ogaenics)	Email + LinkedIn	Faire as instant fallback
Naturtreu	**Manuel Schneider, Account Manager B2B** (LinkedIn search) / **b2b.naturtreu.de** registration	B2B portal + LinkedIn	Named contact = lowest friction
BRAINEFFECT	brain-effect.com/en/pages/business-partner form / Fabian Foelsch (LinkedIn: fabian-foelsch-63b04490)	B2B form + founder LinkedIn	Act 2026, pre-integration
Her.one	**hello@her.one** / Chanyu Xu (LinkedIn: chanyuxu)	Email + founder direct	Relationship-led, expect a meeting
Sunday Natural	—	—	Do not pursue Phase 1

SOURCES

Ogaenics: ogaenics.com · novel-nutriology.com · faire.com/brand/b_s9prdtqxvx · ogaenics.com/de/impressum · ogaenics.com/en/trader **Naturtreu:** naturtreu.de · b2b.naturtreu.de · naturtreu.de/blogs/pressemitteilungen · meedia.de (Feb 2026 campaign) · naturtreu.at/blogs/pressemitteilungen/naturtreu-x-denns-bio-markt **Sunday Natural:** sunday.de · cvc.com (Jan 2024 acquisition) · bloomberg.com (€800M deal) · verbraucherzentrale-bawue.de (lawsuit) · foodwatch.org (June 2025 report) · northdata.com (HRB 152621 B) **BRAINEFFECT:** brain-effect.com · brain-effect.com/policies/legal-notice · brain-effect.com/en/pages/business-partner · schwabe-group.com (March 2025 acquisition) · northdata.com (HRB 121927 B) · osborneclarke.com · ypog.law **Her.one:** her.one · en.her.one · shop-apotheke.com/marken/her-one · niche-beauty.com/brands/her-one-1024 · crunchbase.com/organization/her1 · theorg.com/org/her1 **Regulatory:** BfR Communication 39/2024 (bfr.bund.de) · BVL press release 6 June 2024 · Verbraucherzentrale vzbv position paper March 2025 · RegAsk ashwagandha regulatory overview 2023-2025